

FINAL PROJECT REPORT

An Employee Requests Installation of Licensed Software Through the Service Catalog

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ServiceNow Software Installation Request Automation

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Project Overview

The project “**An Employee Requests Installation of Licensed Software through the Service Catalog**” focuses on developing a structured software-request process using the **ServiceNow platform**. The system enables employees to request licensed software through a dedicated Service Catalog item instead of relying on informal communication or manual coordination.

The request form captures essential information such as **Software Name, Version, License Justification, and Urgency**. After submission, ServiceNow creates the corresponding **Request (REQ)** and **Requested Item (RITM)** records, maintaining the details entered by the employee.

The request is then processed through the configured **approval workflow**. Based on the approval decision, the request either proceeds to fulfillment or stops from further processing. For an approved request, ServiceNow generates a **Catalog Task (SCTASK)** and assigns it to the **Software Support Team**. The support team performs the required installation and updates the task until completion.

The project also includes **automated notifications, Business Rule-based backend processing, ServiceNow record management, and Update Set configuration** to support controlled deployment. The complete workflow was validated through **functional testing and User Acceptance Testing (UAT)**, covering request submission, REQ/RITM creation, approval, rejection, SCTASK assignment, task completion, automation, notifications, and end-to-end processing.

1.2 Purpose

The purpose of the project is to simplify and standardize the process of requesting licensed software installation through ServiceNow. The solution provides employees with a structured request form, captures the necessary software details, automates the approval and fulfillment process, and enables the request to be tracked throughout its lifecycle.

The main objectives of the project are:

- Provide a standardized Service Catalog item for submitting licensed software installation requests.
- Capture essential request information, including Software Name, Version, License Justification, and Urgency.
- Generate and maintain related ServiceNow records, including REQ, RITM, Approval, and SCTASK.
- Automate the approval and fulfillment workflow using the configured ServiceNow workflow/Flow Designer.
- Route approved requests to the Software Support Team for software installation and fulfillment.
- Enable request tracking and completion while using Update Sets for controlled configuration deployment.

2. IDEATION PHASE

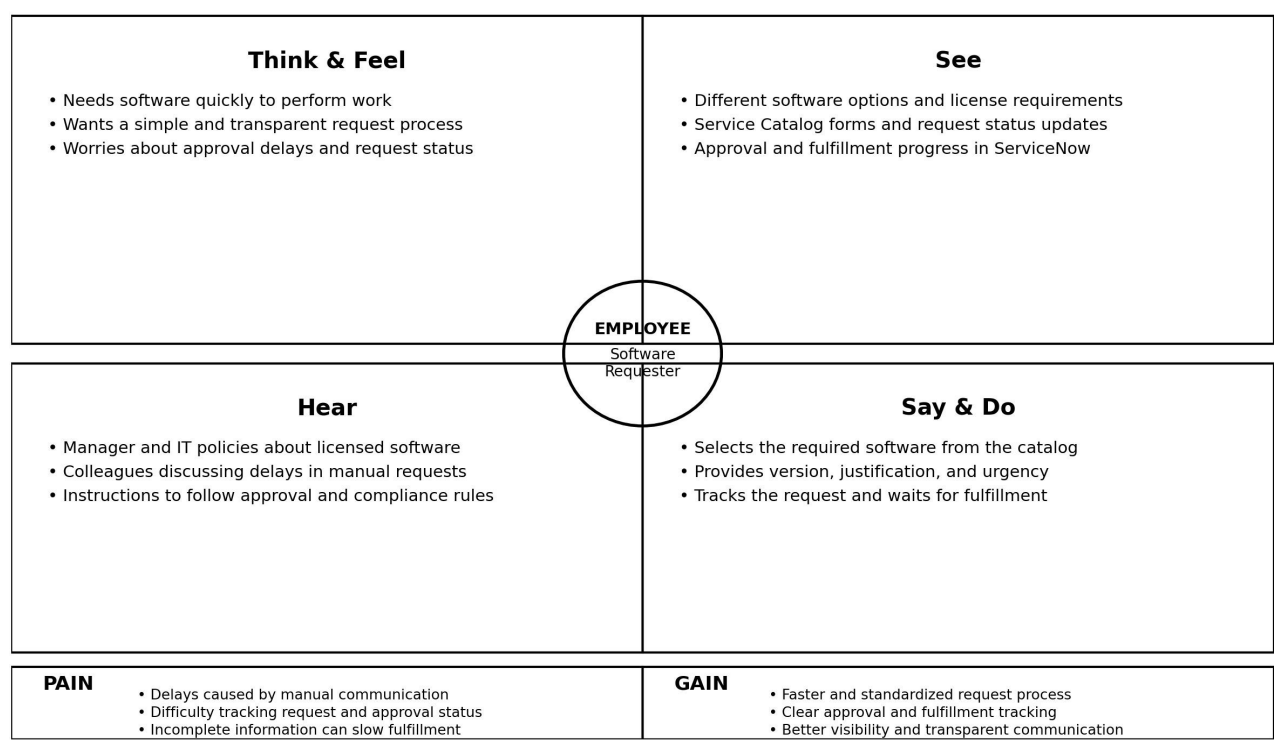
2.1 Problem Statement

Employees who require licensed software for their work may experience delays because the request involves approval, IT coordination, and multiple processing steps. When these activities depend on manual follow-up, employees may have limited visibility into the progress of their request and may be uncertain about when the software will be installed.

Final Customer Problem Statement: I am an employee who needs licensed software for work. I want to request and get the software installed through the Service Catalog, but the process can involve manual coordination and approval delays because multiple people and steps are involved, making me frustrated and uncertain about when my request will be completed.

2.2 Empathy Map Canvas

Empathy Map - Employee Requesting Licensed Software Installation



The empathy map focuses on the employee as the primary user of the ServiceNow software installation request process. The employee wants a quick and transparent request experience, clear approval status, and timely IT fulfillment.

Figure 1. Empathy Map – Employee / Licensed Software Requester

- Needs: fast software installation, clear approval process, and transparent request tracking.
- Pain points: approval or fulfillment delays, manual coordination, and unclear status.
- Expected gain: faster processing, visible status, standardized approval and fulfillment, and a better user experience.

2.3 Brainstorming

Brainstorming was conducted to identify practical ideas for reducing manual effort and improving the licensed software request process. The ideas were grouped around request management, approval, fulfillment, notifications, and request tracking.

Idea	Importance	Feasibility
Service Catalog software request form	High	High
Automated manager / authorized approval	High	High
Create Catalog Task after approval	High	High
Request status tracking	High	High
Email / status notifications	Medium	High

The selected solution is to automate the licensed software installation request using a ServiceNow Service Catalog item, approval flow, and Catalog Task creation. This approach directly addresses the identified problems of manual coordination, approval delays, and limited request visibility, while using the standard ServiceNow capabilities configured for the project.

3. REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS

3.1 Customer Journey Map

The customer journey describes the employee experience from realizing the need for licensed software through request submission, approval, fulfillment, and completion. The key journey stages are Awareness, Request, Approval, Fulfillment, and Completion.

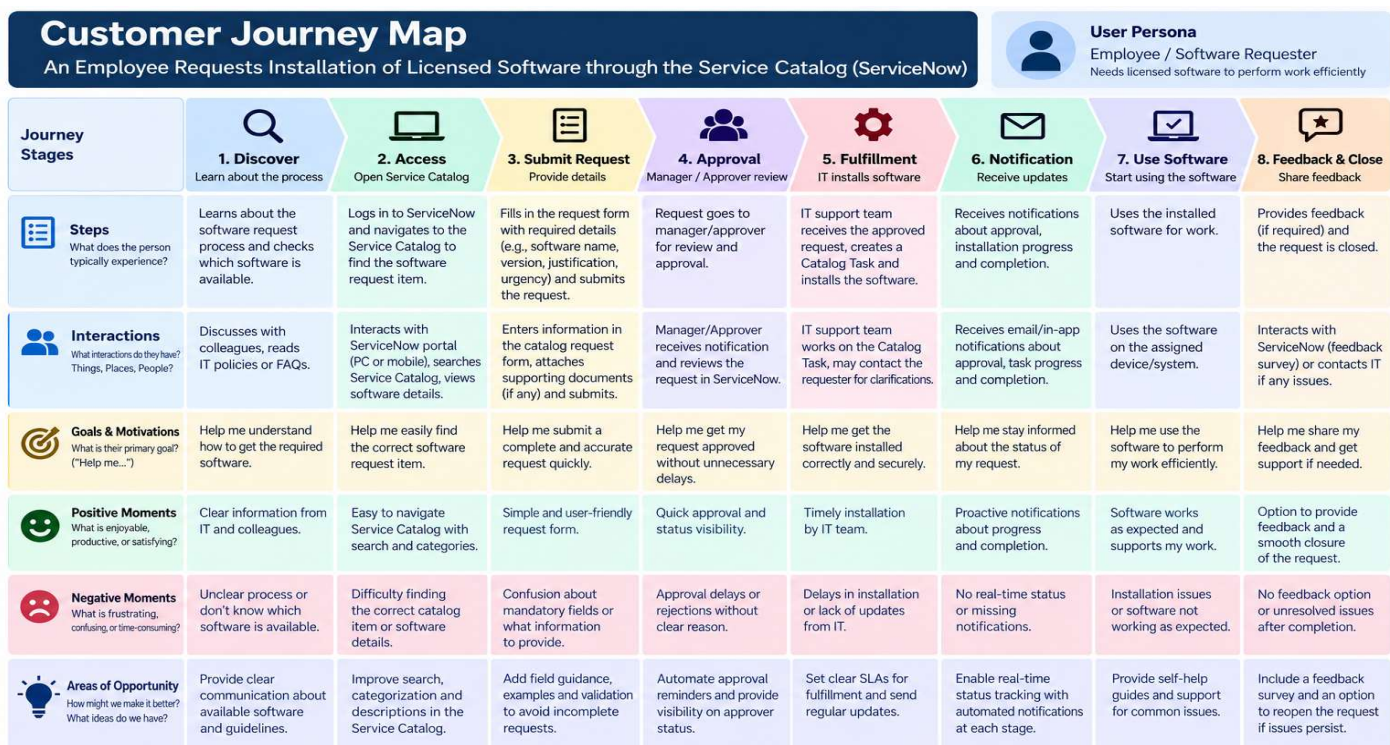


Figure 2. Customer Journey Map – Software Installation Request

The major opportunity areas are to provide a clear Service Catalog item, collect complete request information, automate approval and task creation, provide status visibility, and confirm completion clearly to the employee.

3.2 Solution Requirement

The following functional and non-functional requirements define the expected behavior and quality characteristics of the proposed ServiceNow solution.

Functional Requirements

FR No.	Functional Requirement	Sub Requirement / Expected Behavior
FR-1	Software Request	Employee can open the Service Catalog and submit a licensed software installation request.
FR-2	Request Details	Capture software name, version, license justification, urgency, and other required request information.
FR-3	Approval Management	Route the submitted request to the configured approver for approval or rejection before fulfillment.
FR-4	Fulfillment Task	Create a Catalog Task for the IT/Software Support team after approval.
FR-5	Request Notification	Send a confirmation notification after submission and relevant status updates during processing.
FR-6	Request Tracking	Allow the employee and support team to follow the request, RITM, and task status until completion

Non-functional Requirements

NFR No.	Requirement	Description
NFR-1	Usability	The Service Catalog request form should be clear and easy for employees to understand and complete.
NFR-2	Security	Access to requests, approvals, and fulfillment information should follow appropriate ServiceNow roles and permissions.
NFR-3	Reliability	Requests, approvals, notifications, and fulfillment tasks should be processed consistently without losing request information.
NFR-4	Performance	The system should respond promptly when users submit requests, view records, and update task information.
NFR-5	Availability	The ServiceNow request process should be available when employees and support teams need to submit or process requests

NFR-6	Scalability	The work flow should support an increasing number of software requests without requiring a separate manual process for each request.
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3.3 Data Flow Diagram

The Data Flow Diagram illustrates how a licensed software installation request moves through the ServiceNow platform. The employee initiates the process by submitting the required software details through the Service Catalog. ServiceNow then creates the corresponding Request (REQ) and Requested Item (RITM) records. The request is routed through the configured approval process, where the approval decision determines the next stage of the workflow. Once approved, an SCTASK (Catalog Task) is generated and assigned to the Software Support Team for fulfillment. After the installation activity is completed, the task and request records are updated to maintain the status and history of the request.

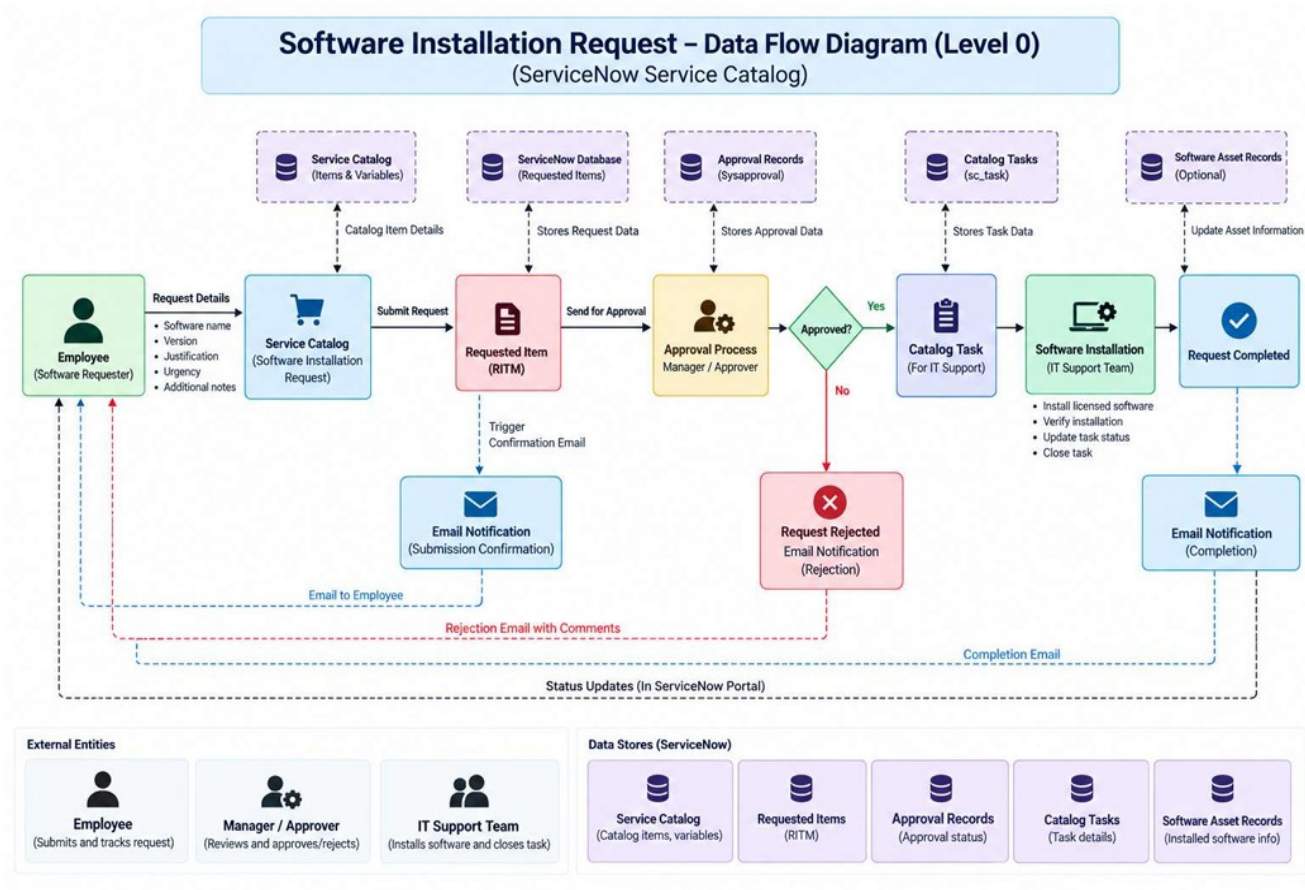


Figure 3. Data Flow Diagram – Software Installation Request Automation

Stage	ServiceNow Record / Table	Purpose
Catalog Request	sc_cat_item	Software installation catalog item
Request	sc_request (REQ)	Stores the overall request
Requested Item	sc_req_item (RITM)	Stores the requested software item and catalog variables
Approval	sysapproval_approver	Stores the approval decision
Fulfillment	sc_task (SCTASK)	Stores the IT / Software Team installation task

3.4 Technology Stack

Component	Technology	Purpose
User Interface	ServiceNow Service Portal / Service Catalog	Employee submits and tracks the software request.
Application Logic	Service Catalog Item + Catalog Variables	Captures Software Name, Version Required, License Justification, and Urgency.
Workflow Automation	ServiceNow Flow Designer / Workflow	Controls approval routing and fulfillment sequence.
Fulfillment	Catalog Task (SCTASK)	Represents installation work assigned to the Software Support Team.
Database / Records	sc_request, sc_req_item, sysapproval_approver, sc_task	Stores request, requested item, approval, and task information.
Backend Automation	ServiceNow Business Rules	Supports assignment, status handling, and related backend logic.
Deployment	ServiceNow Update Sets	Packages and migrates configuration between instances.
Infrastructure	ServiceNow PDI / Enterprise Instance	Hosts and executes the application and workflow.

4. PROJECT DESIGN

4.1 Problem Solution Fit

The problem-solution fit is achieved by replacing manual coordination with a standardized ServiceNow request and an automated approval and fulfillment process. The solution captures the information required to process a software request, routes it for authorization, creates fulfillment work after approval, and supports tracking.

Canvas Area	Project-Specific Definition
Customer Segments	Employees who need licensed software for their work and use ServiceNow to request IT services.
Job-to-be-Done / Problems	Request the required licensed software, obtain approval, and get it installed through a clear and standardized process.

Problem Root Cause	Software installation requires approval and fulfillment coordination; without automation, manual follow-up can delay the request.
Triggers	A work task, project, application requirement, or other approved business need creates the need for licensed software.
Available Solutions	Service Catalog item, required variables, automated approval workflow, Catalog Task creation, tracking, and notifications.
Customer Constraints	Approval and fulfillment coordination can cause delays; employees need clear visibility into request status.
Behaviour	Employee submits details, waits for approval, checks status, and expects IT/Software Team fulfillment.
Channels of Behaviour	Primary channel is the ServiceNow Service Portal / Service Catalog, supported by approval and status communications.
Your Solution	Standardized catalog item + automated approval + SCTASK creation for the Software Support Team.

4.2 Proposed Solution

The proposed solution is a ServiceNow Software Installation Request catalog item connected to an automated approval and fulfillment flow.

1. Employee opens the ServiceNow Service Catalog and selects the Software Installation Request item.
2. The request form captures Software Name, Version Required, License Justification, and Urgency.
3. ServiceNow creates the Request (REQ) and Requested Item (RITM) records.
4. The configured workflow / Flow Designer routes the request to the manager or authorized approver.
5. If the request is approved, ServiceNow creates an SCTASK and assigns it to the Software Support Team.
6. The Software Support Team performs the installation and updates the task to completion.
7. Business Rules and notifications support backend processing and status communication.
8. The configuration is captured in an Update Set so it can be migrated and validated in another instance.

Parameter	Proposed Solution
Problem to be solved	Manual coordination, approval delays, and limited visibility during licensed software installation requests.
Idea / Solution	ServiceNow Service Catalog item with automated approval and fulfillment workflow.
Novelty / Uniqueness	A single standardized request connects catalog data, approval, fulfillment, tracking, and deployment configuration.
Customer Satisfaction	Faster and more transparent request handling with clear ownership and status.
Business Value	Reduces manual coordination and standardizes the software request lifecycle.
Scalability	Additional software items, approval rules, users, and fulfillment tasks can be added on the ServiceNow platform.

4.3 Solution Architecture

The solution architecture connects the employee-facing Service Catalog with the ServiceNow data layer, approval automation, backend logic, fulfillment task, notifications, and Update Set deployment process.

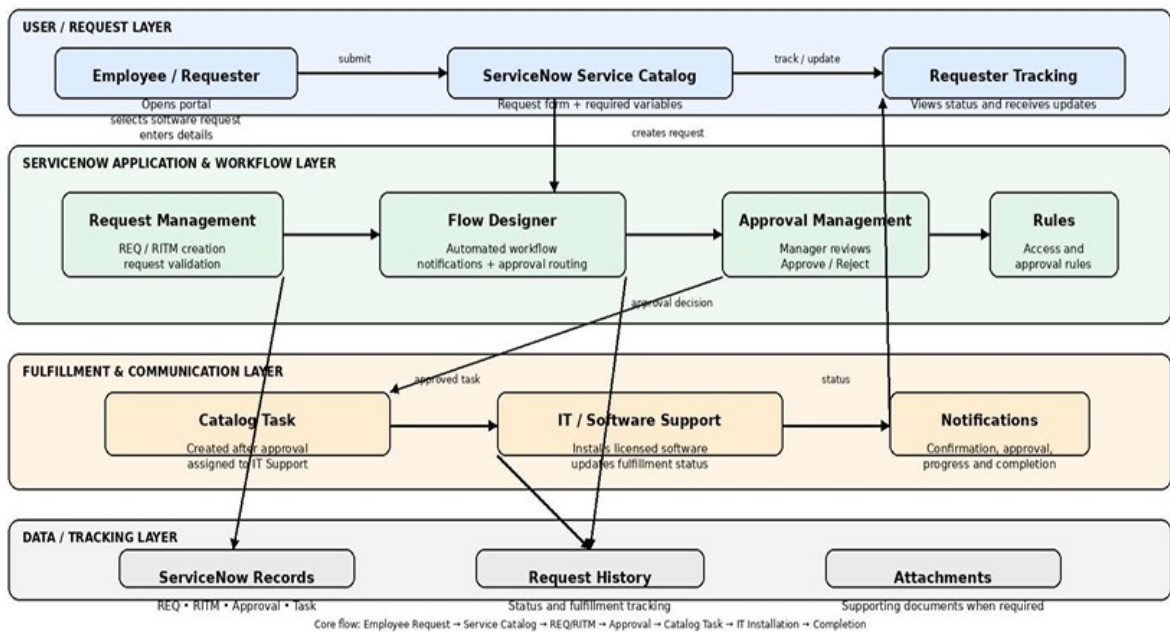


Figure 4. Solution Architecture – ServiceNow Software Installation Request Automation

Component	Purpose
Employee / Requestor	Initiates the licensed software installation request.
Service Catalog	Provides the standardized request item and captures required variables.
ServiceNow Data Layer	Stores REQ and RITM request information.

Component	Purpose
Approval	Manager or authorized approver reviews and approves/rejects the request.
Workflow / Flow Designer	Controls the automated request, approval, and fulfillment sequence.
Business Rules	Support backend logic such as task assignment and status handling.
Catalog Task (SCTASK)	Represents fulfillment work assigned to the Software Support Team.
Notifications	Communicate important request, approval, and completion status.
Update Sets	Package and migrate configured ServiceNow changes.

5. PROJECT PLANNING & SCHEDULING

5.1 Project Planning

The project was organized into four planned sprints with eight user stories and a total of 23 planned story points. The plan covers requirement analysis, Service Catalog configuration, data architecture, approval automation, fulfillment, Business Rules, notifications, testing, and Update Set deployment.

Sprint	User Story	Epic	Story Points	Priority	Planned Scope
Sprint-1	US-01	Requirement Analysis & Planning	2	High	Access standardized Software Installation Request catalog item.
Sprint-1	US-02	Service Catalog	3	High	Capture Software Name, Version Required, License Justification, and Urgency.
Sprint-1	US-03	Data Architecture	3	High	Capture and relate REQ, RITM, and SCTASK data.
Sprint-2	US-04	Workflow Approval	3	High	Allow authorized approver to approve or reject the request.
Sprint-2	US-05	Workflow Approval	3	High	Continue approved requests to fulfillment and stop rejected requests.
Sprint-3	US-06	Fulfillment Business Rules	3	High	Create and complete the fulfillment task for Software Support.
Sprint-3	US-07	Business Rules & Notifications	2	Medium	Provide important request and fulfillment updates.
Sprint-4	US-08	Testing, Security & Deployment	4	High	Test, package, migrate, and validate the solution using an Update Set.

Sprint Schedule

Sprint	Story Points	Duration	Planned Scope
Sprint-1	8	Planned	Requirement analysis, Service Catalog, variables, and REQ/RITM data structure.
Sprint-2	6	Planned	Approval workflow and automation logic.
Sprint-3	5	Planned	Catalog Task fulfillment, Business Rules, and notifications.
Sprint-4	4	Planned	Testing, Update Set, migration, and final validation.

Planned total story points: 23. Planned average velocity: 5.75 story points per sprint.

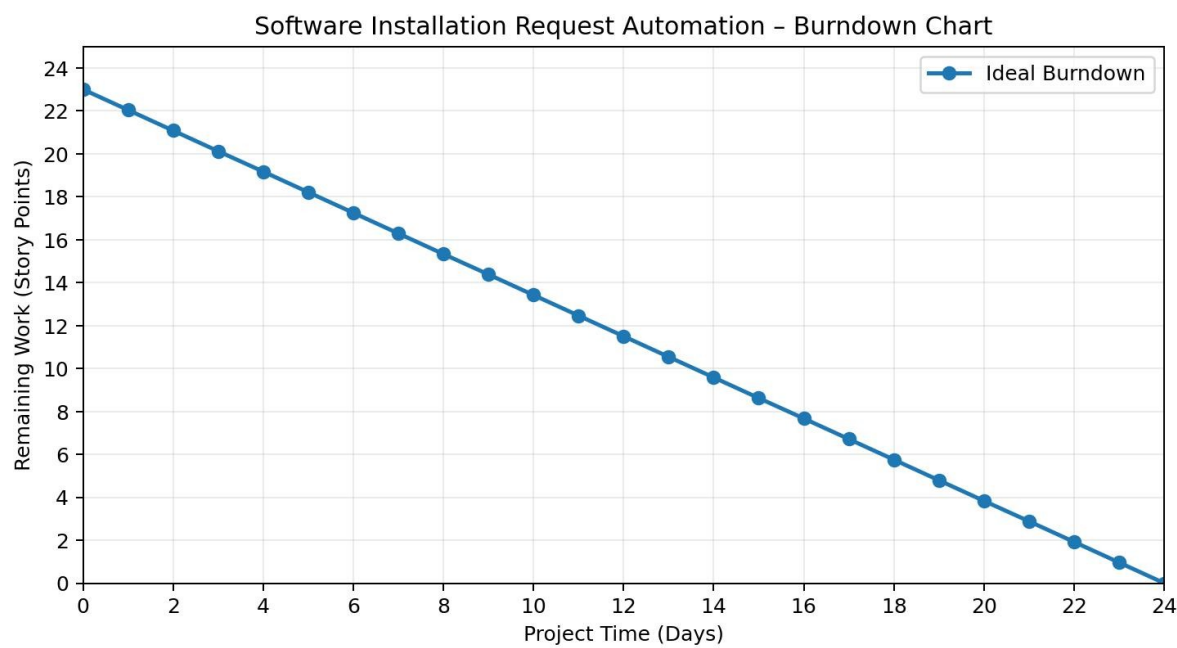


Figure 5. Project Planning / Burndown Representation

Checkpoint	Ideal Remaining Story Points	Actual Remaining
Project Start	23	Completed during project execution
End of Sprint-1	15	Completed during project execution
End of Sprint-2	9	Completed during project execution
End of Sprint-3	4	Completed during project execution
End of Sprint-4 / Completion	0	Completed during project execution

6. FUNCTIONAL AND PERFORMANCE TESTING

6.1 Performance Testing

Performance validation for this project focuses on correct and consistent processing of the software installation request through the Service Catalog, REQ, RITM, approval, SCTASK, automation, and Update Set stages. The testing confirms that the configured flow processes the request without missing records or workflow breaks.

S.No.	Parameter	Validation	Result
1	Service Catalog Item	Catalog item loads correctly and displays the required request fields.	Pass
2	Request Data Capture	Software Name, Version Required, License Justification, and Urgency are captured.	Pass
3	REQ and RITM Processing	REQ and RITM are created and submitted values are retained.	Pass
4	Approval Workflow	Request reaches the configured approver and approval is recorded before fulfillment.	Pass
5	SCTASK Processing	SCTASK is created after approval, assigned to Software Support, and can be completed.	Pass
6	Automation & Data Integrity	Configured backend automation works and project configuration is captured for deployment.	Pass

Functional validation summary

Test Area	Expected Outcome	Status
Service Catalog & Request Submission	Request item is accessible and required details can be submitted.	Pass
REQ & RITM Processing	REQ and RITM are generated and retain the submitted catalog variables.	Pass
Approval & Fulfillment	Approval is recorded and approved requests create an SCTASK.	Pass
Task Completion	Software Support Team can complete the SCTASK.	Pass
Business Rule / Automation	Configured backend automation executes as intended.	Pass
Update Set & Deployment Readiness	Configuration is captured and prepared for migration.	Pass
End-to-End Validation	Complete lifecycle works from request submission through completion.	Pass

7. RESULTS

7.1 Output Screenshots

The following evidence points should be included in the final submission. The report is structured so that the ServiceNow screenshots can be inserted directly below the corresponding result. The navigation descriptions are aligned with the implemented project flow.

Output 1 – Service Catalog Item

ServiceNow → All → Service Catalog / Maintain Items → open the Software Installation Request catalog item. Show the item and request form.

Catalog Item
Software Installation Request

?

...

Copy

Try It

Update

Edit in Catalog Builder

Delete

Catalog items are goods or services available to order from the service catalog. Items can be anything from hardware, like tablets and phones, to software applications, to furniture and office supplies.

• Enter a Name and Short description to display for the item.

• Enter a Price, approvals, variables, and other information as needed.

Name

Software Installation Request

Catalogs

×

Service Catalog

Category

Software

Q

i

State

-- None --

Checked out

-- None --

Owner

System Administrator

Q

i

Application

Global

i

Active

☒

Fulfillment automation level

Unspecified

Item Details

Process Engine

Picture

Pricing

Portal Settings

Short description

Request to install company-approved software.

Description

<>

–

+

Output 2 – Request Submission

Service Portal → Service Catalog → Software Installation Request → enter Software Name, Version Required, License Justification, and Urgency → Submit. Show the completed form or submission confirmation.

Service Catalog > Software > Software Installation Request

...

Search catalog

Request to install company-approved software.

Allows employees to request software installations. Fulfills via Software Support Team.

What software do you need?

Specify version (if required).

Why do you need this software?

Select urgency level.

High

Order this item

Quantity

1

Delivery time

2 Days

Order Now

Add to Cart

Shopping Cart

Empty

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Output 3 – REQ

ServiceNow → All → Service Catalog → Requests → open the generated REQ. Show the request number and requested-for information.

RequestREQ0010004

FollowUpdateCancel RequestCopyDelete

NumberREQ0010004

Opened2026-09-07 07:00:57

Requested forJahnavi Morla

Opened byJahnavi Morla

Location

ApprovalApproved

Due date2026-09-09 07:00:56

Request stateApproved

Price\$0.00

Description

Short description

Output 4 – RITM

Open the REQ → Requested Items → open the RITM. Show the submitted catalog variables.

Requested ItemRITM0010004

FollowUpdateDelete

NumberRITM0010004

Opened2026-09-07 07:00:56

ItemSoftware Installation Request

Opened byJahnavi Morla

RequestREQ0010004

StageAssess or Scope Task

Requested forJahnavi Morla

StateOpen

Due date2026-09-09 07:00:56

Quantity1

Configuration item

Estimated delivery

Watch list

Backordered

Order Guide

Variables

What software do you need?

Microsoft Office 365

Specify version (if required).

2021

Why do you need this software?

Required for daily work

Output 5 – Approval

ServiceNow → All → My Approvals / Approvals → open the approval record for the software request.
Show the approver and Approved state.

Approval

ApproverJahnavi Morla

StateApproved

Approval forRITM0010004

Approval Reason

Summary of Item being approved:

Description	Price	Quantity	Total
Request to install company-approved software.	\$0.00	1	\$0.00

Comments

Post

Activities: 2

JM Jahnavi Morla

StateApproved was Not Yet Requested

Field changes • 2026-09-22 11:21:01

JM Jahnavi Morla

ApproverJahnavi Morla

StateNot Yet Requested

Field changes • 2026-09-22 11:18:04

Output 6 – SCTASK

Open the related Requested Item → Catalog Tasks, or navigate to Catalog Tasks and open the generated SCTASK. Show Assignment Group = Software Support and the request item reference.

Catalog Task
SCTASK0010009

NumberSCTASK0010009

Assigned to

Configuration item

Active

ApprovalNot Yet Requested

Priority4 - Low

StatePending

Request itemRITM0010004

Requested forJahnavi Morla

Short descriptionProvide requested service

Description

Work notes

Post

Activities: 1

JM Jahnavi Morla

Impact3 - Low

Opened byJahnavi Morla

Priority4 - Low

StatePending

Field changes • 2026-09-07 07:00:56

Output 7 – Task Completion

Open the SCTASK → update the task after installation → show State = Closed Complete.

Catalog Task
SCTASK0010009

Number

SCTASK0010009

Assigned to

Configuration item

Active

☐

Approval

Not Yet Requested

Priority

4 - Low

State

Closed Complete

Request item

RITM0010004

Requested for

Jahnavi Morla

Short description

Provide requested service

Description

Work notes

Work notes

Post

Activities: 2

JM Jahnavi Morla

State Closed Complete was Pending

JM Jahnavi Morla

Impact 3 - Low

Opened by Jahnavi Morla

Priority 4 - Low

State Pending

Field changes • 2026-09-22 11:28:59

Field changes • 2026-09-07 07:00:56

Output 8 – Business Rule / Automation

ServiceNow → All → System Definition → Business Rules → open the configured Business Rule.
Show the rule name, condition, and active configuration.

Business Rule
License Issue

Name

License Issue

Table

Requested Item [sc_req_item]

Application

Global

Active

☒

Advanced

☒

run

Actions

Advanced

Condition

current.state.changesTo(3)

Script

Turn on ECMAScript 2021 (ES12) mode

```
1 (function executeRule(current, previous /*null when async*/) {
2
3   if (current.state.changesTo(3)) {
4
5     var inc = new GlideRecord('incident');
6     inc.initialize();
7
8     inc.short_description = 'License unavailable for ' + current.request_item;
9     inc.description = 'Software request could not be fulfilled due to license shortage.';
10    inc.caller_id = current.request.requested_for;
11    inc.assignment_group.setDisplayValue('Software Support');
12    inc.priority = 3;
13
14    inc.insert();
15  }
16}
```

Output 9 – Update Set

ServiceNow → All → System Update Sets → Local Update Sets → open the project Update Set. Show captured configuration and completed state; for migration, show Retrieve Update Sets if applicable.

Update Set
Software Installation Request Setup

* NameSoftware Installation Request Setup

StateComplete

Parent

Release date

Install date

Installed from

ApplicationGlobal

Created2026-09-05 05:21:14

Created byjahnvimorla

Merged to

Description

Update set for software installation request workflow and business rules.

Update

Related Links

Merge With Another Update Set

Scan Update Set

SN Utils | Versions (0)

Customer Updates (11)

Update Set Logs

Child Update Sets

Install History

Created

Search

Actions on selected rows...

	Created	Type	View	Target name	Updated by	Remote update set	Action
☐	2026-09-07 06:51:15	Variable		What software do you need?	jahnvimorla	(empty)	INSERT_OR_UPDATE
☐	2026-09-07 06:52:15	Variable		Specify version (if required).	jahnvimorla	(empty)	INSERT_OR_UPDATE

Overall Result: The implemented project provides a complete ServiceNow workflow for licensed software installation requests. The tested lifecycle covers catalog submission, REQ/RITM creation, approval, SCTASK creation and assignment, task completion, backend automation, Update Set handling, and end-to-end validation.

8. ADVANTAGES & DISADVANTAGES

Advantages	Disadvantages / Limitations
• Standardized software request process.	• The solution depends on correct ServiceNow configuration and permissions.
• Reduces manual coordination and follow-up.	• Approval delays can still occur when an approver does not act promptly.
• Captures complete request information using catalog variables.	• Actual software installation still requires the Software Support Team.
• Automates approval and fulfillment task creation.	• Notifications and integrations may require additional configuration for a production environment.
• Provides clear ownership through Software Support assignment.	• The project does not include external APIs or machine-learning functionality.
• Supports request history, status visibility, and controlled	

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Advantages	Disadvantages / Limitations
deployment.	
• Can be extended to additional software and approval rules.	

9. CONCLUSION

The Software Installation Request Automation project demonstrates how ServiceNow can be used to standardize and automate the complete lifecycle of a licensed software request. The process begins with a structured Service Catalog item, where employees provide the required software details. ServiceNow then generates the related REQ and RITM records, routes the request through the configured approval process, and creates an SCTASK for the Software Support Team once approval is completed.

The project also demonstrates the use of Business Rules for backend automation, ServiceNow tables for managing request and task information, and Update Sets for controlled configuration migration. The implemented workflow was validated through functional testing and UAT across request submission, record creation, approval, fulfillment, task completion, notifications, and deployment configuration.

Overall, the solution provides a consistent and structured software-request process, reduces dependency on manual coordination, and provides employees with a clearer process for tracking their request from submission through fulfillment.

10. FUTURE SCOPE

The following enhancements can be considered to further extend the capabilities of the Software Installation Request Automation system:

- Integrate with Software Asset Management or license-management systems to automatically verify software license availability.
- Implement dynamic approval rules based on factors such as software type, cost, department, and request urgency.
- Introduce automatic license availability checks before the request reaches the approval stage.
- Integrate with endpoint-management tools to automate software installation directly on employee devices.
- Implement SLA monitoring, escalation mechanisms, and dashboards to track request turnaround time and fulfillment performance.
- Enhance employee notifications through email and in-app channels to provide timely updates throughout the request lifecycle.
- Expand the Service Catalog to support multiple software products and standardized installation packages.
- Add knowledge articles and troubleshooting guidance to help employees and support teams resolve common software installation issues.

11. APPENDIX

A. Source Code (if any)

The project primarily uses ServiceNow configuration, Flow Designer / workflow activities, catalog variables, tables, and Business Rules. The following is the Business Rule logic used in the project to create an incident when the fulfillment process reaches the configured On Hold condition because the requested software license is unavailable.

```
if (current.state == 3) { // On Hold
    var inc = new GlideRecord('incident');
    inc.initialize();
    inc.short_description = 'License unavailable for ' + current.request_item;
    inc.description = 'Software request could not be fulfilled due to license shortage.';
    inc.caller_id = current.request.requested_for;
    inc.assignment_group.setDisplayValue('Software Support');
    inc.priority = 3;
    inc.insert();
}
```

B. Dataset Link

Not applicable. This project is a ServiceNow workflow/configuration project and does not use a separate dataset.

C. GitHub & Project Demo Link

GitHub Link:

<https://github.com/JahnaviMorla/Software-Installation-Request-Automation---ServiceNowProject> Demo Link:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/142Ga3_Qd1C03w8P87mcRbeallnXIIIfPM/view?usp=drive_link